

Do These 5 Things Every Morning to Make Fat Loss Easier

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 20, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=29QQgOir9NQ> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Veteran personal trainer Brandon Carter, 43, shares five morning practices — peptides, testosterone replacement therapy, pre-workout caffeine, skipping breakfast carbs, drinking half a gallon of water, and 30 minutes of fasted walking — that he credits with making fat loss dramatically easier, especially for men over 40.

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Thing 1: Peptides 0:23

- Brandon's overarching philosophy: "You don't get credit for doing things the more difficult way."
 - He started peptides earlier in the year of filming and calls them a "game changer."
- **Always consult your doctor before starting any of these compounds** — he repeats this emphatically multiple times.
- The four peptides he personally takes:
 - **Tessamorelin** — a growth-hormone-releasing hormone analog; he implies it supports fat loss and energy.
 - **BPC-157** — he takes it primarily at night; helps with injuries, aches, and pains (especially relevant for men in their 40s); promotes deep sleep; increases growth hormone; has been "proven to help burn belly fat."
 - **Tirzepatide (Trizepatide/"Traceide")** — a GLP-1/GIP receptor agonist; completely suppresses hunger, removing the need for dietary discipline; the main challenge becomes eating *enough*, not too little.
 - **Mazibi ("Matzi")** — mentioned briefly; provides energy during deep caloric deficits.

- Key point on tirzepatide: removes hunger so thoroughly that the only discipline required is to avoid under-eating.
- BPC-157 highlighted specifically for men 40+ dealing with joint pain and slow recovery.

Thing 2: Testosterone Replacement Therapy (TRT) 1:32

- Natural testosterone begins declining at age 20 for most men; for some, it starts at 25.
- Brandon started TRT "right before I turned 40, like maybe a year or two before."
 - At the time he started, his tested level was **400–500 ng/dL** — down from **~1,200 ng/dL** in his 20s.
 - He and his doctor maintain his levels at around **900 ng/dL** — his described "sweet spot."
- Benefits he personally experienced:
 - Much more energy and feeling better overall.
 - Easier to cut (lose fat) while maintaining muscle — especially notable because a natural caloric deficit itself lowers testosterone, which TRT counteracts.
 - More stable mood; at 900 ng/dL he reports no anger/aggression side effects.
- TRT vs. steroids distinction:
 - His natural level at 22 was 1,200; his TRT level now is 900 — so he has **less** testosterone than he did naturally as a young man.
 - He is not noticeably bigger than he was then; this is replacement, not supraphysiological dosing.
- **Dosing protocol:** He injects daily in small amounts rather than weekly or bi-weekly.
 - Reason: daily microdosing keeps estrogen more stable and avoids the peaks and valleys of less frequent injections.
- Who should consider TRT: men over 40 who get blood work done and find low levels.
- Who should NOT get on TRT: men whose testosterone is already at 800+ ng/dL — it won't be helpful.
- Action step: Get blood work done, talk to a doctor, and ask specifically about tirzepatide, tressamorelin, BPC-157, and testosterone.

Thing 3: Chug a Pre-Workout Immediately Upon Waking 3:49

- He has followed this habit for **over a decade**.
- Protocol:
 - Mixes the pre-workout the night before so it is ready to go.
 - Drinks it within **60 seconds** of his alarm going off — before he even urinates.
- Why it works for him:
 - Without caffeine in the morning he describes a slow, gradual warm-up feeling.
 - With pre-workout: "It's like someone lit a match in a room full of gasoline."
- Caffeine timing insight: caffeine takes approximately **30 minutes** to enter the bloodstream.

- He uses this window productively — drink pre-workout → urinate → **meditate for 20 minutes** → by the time meditation ends, caffeine is kicking in and he's ready to attack the day.
- He notes he had already taken pre-workout before filming this video, which he acknowledges explains his heightened energy on camera.

Thing 4: No Carbs at Breakfast 4:57

- The science behind the recommendation:
 - Carbohydrates convert to glucose/glycogen.
 - When blood glucose rises above **110 mg/dL**, the pancreas secretes insulin.
 - Insulin indiscriminately flushes excess glucose from everywhere in the body, including the brain — causing the post-meal energy crash many people experience.
- Common breakfast offenders he calls out: Pop-Tarts, sugary cereal, pancakes with syrup, muffins ("muffins were invented as an excuse for people to eat cake for breakfast").
- His own breakfast foods:
 - **1–2 cans of sardines** as the very first food of the day.
 - Later (~11 AM): eggs, a big salad, and a bowl of berries.
 - Berries are his preferred fruit because they are low on the glycemic index and don't spike glucose significantly — he attributes their lower sugar content to their natural sourness vs. sweeter fruits like papaya.
- He has been **keto for 11 years**.
 - Protein converts to glucose via **gluconeogenesis**, which keeps his muscles looking full even without dietary carbohydrates.
 - The glucose from gluconeogenesis goes into muscle reserves; because he's fat-adapted, his body runs primarily on fat.
- If you don't want to go fully keto:
 - Push carbs toward the **end of the day** or **around your workout** — when rising glucose can be burned off directly rather than requiring insulin to clear it.

Thing 5: Drink Half a Gallon of Water 7:17

- He drinks roughly **half a gallon of water** before his day truly begins.
- His morning water breakdown:
 - 16 oz from the pre-workout drink.
 - 40 oz additional water within the first hour of waking.
 - Total: **56 oz before the day starts**.
- His daily target: **two gallons of water per day** — he describes himself as aiming to be "hyper hydrated."
- Mechanisms by which water aids fat loss:

- **Water-induced thermogenesis:** Drinking cold water forces the body to burn energy to maintain core temperature at 98°F; can temporarily elevate resting energy burn for **up to an hour** after consumption (he notes the effect varies by person but compounds over time).
- **Lipolysis support:** Fat burning is a two-part process:
 - *Lipolysis* — fat cells are broken down into fatty acids.
 - *Oxidation* — the body uses those fatty acids for energy.
 - Even mild dehydration causes cells to shrink, which **directly impairs lipolysis**. Better hydration = more effective fat burning.
- **Appetite suppression:** Preloading with water before meals leads to eating less; he cites studies supporting this.
- Additional benefits: clearer skin, injury prevention, and overall improved performance.
- On fears of overhydration: he dismisses this as nearly impossible under normal voluntary drinking — "Your body would reject it and throw up."

Thing 5 (Bonus/Top Pick): 30 Minutes of Fasted Walking 9:38

- He frames this as his **top recommendation** for morning fat loss.
- His full morning sequence:
 - Wake up → drink pre-workout → urinate → meditate 20 min → pre-workout kicks in → **30-minute fasted walk**.
- **Important clarification on fasted cardio research:**
 - A study showed that when calories and protein are matched, fasted cardio and fed cardio burn the **same total amount of fat over a 24-hour period**.
 - So fasted walking is not a direct calorie-burning "hack" — the real benefit is elsewhere.
- Why he does it fasted — actual benefits:
 - **Fat oxidation during the session:** Exercising fasted significantly increases the proportion of fat burned *during* that workout (even if the 24-hour total evens out, the metabolic training effect matters).
 - **Metabolic flexibility:** Training the body to switch between burning glucose and burning fat without crashing — he defines this as the ability to run efficiently off either fuel source.
 - He gets glucose via gluconeogenesis from protein even while keto, so his muscles stay fueled.
 - **Improved insulin sensitivity:** Insulin sensitivity is at its highest immediately upon waking; training fasted in that state has been shown to improve whole-body glucose tolerance *more* than training fed. Result: when you eat after fasted training, nutrients are shuttled into muscles rather than stored as fat.
 - **The "domino effect":** Studies show people who exercise at a consistent morning time have better long-term exercise adherence and weight management because it gets done before work, meetings, and life interruptions.
 - Practical preference: pre-workout hits harder when fasting; he doesn't enjoy exercising while digesting food.

- How he does his walk — the "Clawed Walk":
 - 30 minutes; outdoors, on his balcony, or on the treadmill in his condo gym.
 - Multitasks during the walk: talks through problems, scripts videos, responds to emails from his team and students, or helps students in his coaching program.

Sponsor Segment: High Ticket Trainer Program 11:58

- Brandon mentions his business teaching people to grow online fitness businesses.
 - Claims to have helped **over 15,000 people** grow their online fitness business.
- Student success story: **Jen Caesar** — a full-time nurse with two kids and no prior training clients.
 - Joined his program "High Ticket Trainer."
 - Within the **first 6 months**: reached **~\$50K/month** in revenue.
 - Now earning **over \$100K/month** as an online trainer.
- Free tool offered: **Fitness Revenue Roadmap** — an AI tool built on his 27 years of experience.
 - User answers a few questions (takes a few minutes).
 - AI assesses where they are and provides a step-by-step plan to build an online fitness business.
 - Described as suitable for complete beginners (no Instagram presence yet) through established trainers with existing clients.
 - Link available in the video description and pinned comment.